Writing link text

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There are three key rules to keep in mind when writing quality link text:

Link text should be:

1. **Short** enough to quickly read
2. **Descriptive** enough to know where it will take you
3. In **context** with the surrounding text and the destination webpage.

> **Tip**
> When judging the quality of a link, consider *only the link text* for the **short** and **descriptive** rules. For the **context** rule, consider the *surrounding content* and the *link destination*.

Additional tips:

- Use the page title or a description of the destination page.
- Include file type & size at the end of a download link. E.g. "Sign up form (PDF, 3MB)"
- Don't use the general phrases like "click here", "read more", "see info" or "this document".
- Don't use a URL as link text.
- Don't include punctuation at start or end of link text.

For more information, see links in the Telstra's Content Style Guide and click on "Links & URLs" on the left hand side navigation.

Examples

A great way to search the web is by using Google.	**1. Short**	✅
	2. Descriptive	✅
	3. Context	✅

This example links to a company's homepage, and it passes all 3 rules.

Start your path to learning music with these books.	**1. Short**	✅
	2. Descriptive	❌
	3. Context	✅

This link opens a page with list of music books. It's **short**, but not **descriptive** enough to know that it's related to music. Keyboard or screen reader users may expect this to go to a web page about books.

The koala, kangaroo, wallaby and wombat are all native marsupials from Australia.	**1. Short**	✅
	2. Descriptive	✅
	3. Context	❌

The sentence is about Australian native marsupials, but the link destination goes to a page about Australia, which is out of **context**.

Although not recognised at the time, Vincent Van Gogh is regarded as one of the most important painters of the 19th century.	**1. Short**	✅
	2. Descriptive	✅
	3. Context	✅

Take "painters of the 19th century"; it's **short** and **descriptive** to know what to expect. Additionally, when considering the whole sentence, the **context** is relevant.

Although not recognised at the time, Vincent Van Gogh is regarded as one of the most important painters of the 19th century.	**1. Short**	❌
	2. Descriptive	✅
	3. Context	✅

This link is too long, which makes it difficult for user to understand it quickly. Additionally it's not clear what the link destination is.

Although not recognised at the time, Vincent Van Gogh is regarded as one of the most important painters of the 19th century.	**1. Short**	✅
	2. Descriptive	❌
	3. Context	✅

Consider the just the link text "recognised at the time" alone, it is unclear what the link is about.

Although not recognised at the time, Vincent Van Gogh is regarded as one of the most important painters of the 19th century.	**1. Short**	✅
	2. Descriptive	✅
	3. Context	❌

This sentence is referring to "painters of the 19th century", so linking to a destination about "the 19th century" is misleading and out of **context**.

No labels

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